

Current Events Presentations

Guidelines & Rubric – ECO 112, Fall 2026

Overview

Starting Week 6, small groups will lead a short presentation connecting that week's chapter to a real, current economic event. The goal isn't a polished TED talk – it's showing you can take an abstract concept from lecture and actually *use* it to make sense of something happening right now.

There are **7 presentation slots** across the semester (Ch 7, 8, 10, 11, 12, 14-15, 16-17). Group sizes and the sign-up schedule will be posted on Moodle once enrollment is finalized.

What to Prepare

1. **Find one article or video** (published within the last ~12 months) that connects to that week's chapter – a news article, a Federal Reserve or BLS/BEA report, a Planet Money or similar podcast episode, etc.
2. **Prepare a short presentation (8-10 minutes):**
 - Briefly summarize the article/video (don't assume the class read it)
 - Explain the economic concept(s) from the chapter that it illustrates
 - State clearly: what does this article get right or wrong, from an economics standpoint?
3. **Prepare 2-3 discussion questions** to open up to the class afterward (5-10 minutes of discussion time).

Logistics

- Presentations happen on **Thursdays**, at the start of class.
- Every group member should speak for some portion of the presentation.
- Slides are optional but recommended for anything with data or a chart – a one-page hand-out works fine too.
- Submit your source article/video link to the instructor by **the Monday before** your presentation slot.

AI Policy: Yellow

AI is fine for finding articles or brainstorming discussion questions – not for writing your analysis or answers. The real test happens live, fielding questions in front of the class.

Grading Rubric (100 points)

Criterion	Points	What we're looking for
Article relevance & currency	15	Source is genuinely recent and clearly connects to the week's chapter – not a stretch.
Accuracy of economic content	25	Concepts from the chapter are explained correctly and applied appropriately to the article.
Clarity & organization	20	Presentation has a clear structure; the class can follow the argument without having read the source themselves.
Critical engagement	20	Goes beyond summarizing – identifies what the article gets right/wrong, or what it leaves out.
Discussion questions & facilitation	15	Questions are genuinely discussable (not yes/no); group manages the discussion rather than just reading questions off a slide.
Team delivery	5	All group members participate meaningfully.

Grade Bands

- **90-100:** Sharp article choice, correct and well-applied economics, genuinely sparks discussion.
- **75-89:** Solid effort, mostly correct economics, discussion questions land but may need instructor prompting.
- **60-74:** Article connection is loose or economics has real gaps; presentation is more summary than analysis.

- **Below 60:** Article not clearly relevant, economic content is largely incorrect, or discussion component is missing.

A Few Tips

- The best presentations pick an article that has some tension or ambiguity in it – a policy debate, a surprising data release, a case where people disagree about the right interpretation. A totally settled, uncontroversial article makes for a short discussion.
- FRED (fred.stlouisfed.org) is a great place to pull an actual chart to show alongside your article – real data makes the presentation land better than description alone.